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Chapter 7

Drinks Sales Order Processing

Overview



Introduction

The recording and progressing of a company's sales orders is a basic commercial activity. It could be argued that it is the most important, for if a company ceases to satisfy its customers, it cannot expect to continue to survive.

Computer systems have been used for many years to help companies record and manage their customers' orders. Increasingly, service is being used as a way of differentiating a company from its competitors. In order to achieve this 'Right First Time' philosophy in all dealings with the customer, a flexible and comprehensive Sales Order Processing module is required.

Drinks Sales Order Processing has a breadth of functions, which not only enable it to be used by a variety of commercial organisations, but also to change as a company grows and develops in response to a changing environment. To facilitate the growth and expansion of a company, the package has incorporated multi-currency and European functionality. European functionality calculates the correct VAT and identifies the payment terms for the order.

The module is designed to support a rapid 'data entry' style of order entry for use when very few changes or overrides are required. Order entry can also be performed whilst conversing with the customer which supports the greatest level of flexibility including a prompt to assist in offering an alternative item or sourcing from another depot.

Although the module contains a variety of pricing and discounting routines, in certain circumstances it is necessary to enter a negotiated price or discount. The order will be suspended if non standard conditions, such as zero pricing or credit check failure, arise during entry. This allows order taking to continue unhindered, but errors to be trapped.

Day to day decisions are supported by a range of enquiries, which enable stock availability to be projected into the future, customer credit to be examined and orders to be displayed by customer's reference, item number and account.

Relationships to Other Modules

Drinks Sales Order Processing is a fully standardised module.

Careful and detailed planning prior to the introduction of the new module is important. When Drinks Sales Order Processing is installed, two major areas must be considered. These are:

- Have the pre-requisite modules already been installed; and, if so, are they set up in a way which is suitable for the operation of Sales Order Processing?
- How will the functions and facilities of Drinks Sales Order Processing be used to satisfy the company's basic needs?

The following modules are pre-requisites to Drinks Sales Order Processing:

- Drinks Inventory Management
- Accounts Receivable

Normally, Sales Analysis would be installed with Sales Order Processing to provide flexible enquiry and reporting on the sales activity of the company.

What Does It Do?

The fundamental purpose of Drinks Sales Order Processing is to record and control your sales orders. There is a direct relationship between Drinks Inventory Management and Drinks Sales Order Processing. The company must be defined on the Inventory Management order for it to be available on Drinks Sales Order Processing. Similarly, Drinks Sales Order Processing raises invoices for all despatches made from the company and it expects to post them to the customers' accounts in Accounts Receivable.

There is, therefore, a simple relationship between the modules for one company; that is, the modules of Drinks Inventory Management, Accounts Receivable, Drinks Sales Analysis and Drinks Sales Order Processing must share the same two character company code.

A number of Drinks Sales Order Processing functions depend directly on data held in the Accounts Receivable and Drinks Inventory Management modules. These are as follows:

- The currency of the Drinks Sales Order Processing module is determined by the currency setting for the Accounts Receivable company.
- The currency of a customer is determined by the currency setting on the customer's Accounts Receivable account. However, this can be changed at order level.
- Drinks Sales Order Processing may only sell sales kits which have been set up and maintained within the Drinks Inventory Management company.
- Only alternatives set up in the Drinks Inventory Management company will be prompted as replacements for shortages during sales order entry, stock allocation is usually performed by examining the order and choosing the stockroom/depot for the order line. The items must be defined to a valid Drinks Sales Order Processing depot.
- Sales made for kits of items can update Drinks Sales Analysis in a number of ways. These options are controlled on the Item Master record.
- The Analysis Codes on the Item Master record are not only used within Drinks Inventory Management for reporting, but also form the basis of Drinks Sales Analysis. Considerable care must be taken to ensure that the coding structure which is set up will meet the analysis needs for the foreseeable future, as the regeneration of the Drinks Sales Analysis database is time consuming.

Additionally, it is possible to use other modules to improve the control and operation of certain processes:

- Drinks Transport Planning provides the ability to assign customer deliveries to loads. This enables bulk picking lists to be requested and processed.
- Drinks Distribution Requirements Planning enables, among other activities, the ordering, despatch, and receipt of, internal orders from one company's Depot to another.

- Drinks Warehousing provides control systems for the running of a warehouse. This enables picking and marshalling to take place with the specification of locations (shelves/racks/bays etc.) plus pack control.

Using Drinks Sales Order Processing

It is essential that detailed discussions take place which review the facilities offered by the module and that decisions are made as to how each stage of the order cycle will be handled. For example:

- In what circumstances will Sales Order entry be used?
- In what circumstances will Telesales order entry be used?
- How will pricing/discounting be carried out?
- How will pick lists be raised, and how will they be confirmed?
- Under what circumstances will order acknowledgements be sent?
- What use will be made of the priority allocation rules?

All the above are fully discussed in the body of this product information. Some of the decisions require control data to be set up in the modules in order to implement them; others are a matter of agreed procedure; all directly affect the service which you provide to your customers.

Module Configuration

As with all the modules, Drinks Sales Order Processing can be operated for a number of companies, the characteristics of each being maintained on a control file. The module is controlled by setting up data both for the company and for each depot. This will normally occur after the Inventory and Accounts Receivable companies have been created. The Accounts Receivable, Drinks Inventory Management, and Drinks Sales Order Processing all use the same company codes for interfacing.

Certain data and policies may be set up as a default at the company level. These are:

- Company name and address.
- Document reference numbers for orders and invoices.
- Period and week numbers.
- Defaults for additional customer details.
- Borders printed on documents.
- Nominated fields for use as search arguments for customer selection.

These policies and parameters will be used throughout the operation of the system unless overridden at customer or order level.

When Drinks Inventory Management is set up, a number of stockrooms can be created. These will be created for a number of purposes, only some of which may be concerned with sales and distribution. Any stockroom from which sales are to be made must be designated as a depot and defined as such within Drinks Sales Order Processing. As well as address and contact information, allocation parameters can be maintained for each depot.

The other essential factors that need to be considered before the order process can be fully operational are:

- Company profiles.
- Depot profiles.
- Price & discount lists.
- Customer details.
- Descriptions.
- Items.
- Containers.
- Alternatives.
- Kits.

Company Profile

The module requires defaults to be set up prior to undertaking the order process. These can be defined in the company profile, and will apply to all the customers within this company. The issues that need to be addressed are:

- Will you wish generally to allow back orders and part deliveries?
- What is the default priority which you wish to give to new orders, and what are the steps by which that priority is to be incremented when allocation fails?
- Do you want to allow allocation to a level where available stock is negative?
- Do you, as a rule, wish to price orders at order, or despatch time?
- Which fields in the customer database do you wish to use to form part of your customer search facility?

Module Reference Data

The following reference data can be maintained:

- Standard Codes and Descriptions.
- Customers.
- Depot Profiles.
- Prices and Discounts.
- Delivery Note Messages.
- Trailer Details.
- Credit Controllers.
- State & City Profiles.

Standard Codes and Descriptions

A descriptions or parameters file is used by Drinks in most modules for a number of purposes. Primarily, it enables codes to be set up with standard descriptions. This provides for validation at the time of data entry and also the display of descriptions on both screens and reports. In some specific instances a parameter or number is also stored, for example, the case of value added tax percentages.

The module has a small number of standard codes and parameters that must be present for the successful operation of a specific module. Some of these are maintained in Drinks Inventory Management as it is the base module for both Distribution and Manufacturing modules. Maintenance, however, can be performed from most modules, including Drinks Sales Order Processing. There are codes specific to Drinks Sales Order Processing which you will need to set up - e.g. customer classes, cash discounts, extra charges, sales analysis groups etc.

Customers

The information held in the system for customers is of equal interest to those managing and collecting the debt as to those recording and progressing sales orders. The maintenance routines in each module reflect their specific requirements. They both, however, create and maintain a common database with access to common and exclusive information. For example, Drinks Sales Order Processing provides functions to control stock allocation, pricing and sales analysis coding.

The structure of the customer information can be manipulated to match the structure of the customer's organisation. Customer accounts can be set up as single accounts, or as 'statement accounts' with many 'invoice to accounts', each of which may have many 'delivery accounts'.

Statement Account

This is shared with Accounts Receivable. This is created in Accounts Receivable, the data held at this level includes credit details, Accounts Receivable parameters and statistical codes.

Invoice Account

If the statement account address is not the same as the invoice address, a separate invoice account needs to be set up in Drinks Sales Order Processing. This account does not have sales orders assigned to it. Instead the despatch account contains a field in which you can identify an invoice account. The invoice account will contain the address of the customer where the invoice for those deliveries should be sent.

Despatch Account

Many despatch addresses may be set up for an account. This is done by adding a three-character suffix to the eight-character statement account code.

Additional Information

Each account to which items are delivered may have additional data to act as defaults during order entry. It includes data on sales depot, price list, discount list, allocation priority, back order parameters, part deliveries and analysis codes. This enables different parts of a customer's organisation to have different commercial terms and be serviced from a different depot. In Drinks Sales Order Processing extra details are held for sales business control and Customs and Excise (Bond).

Depot Profiles

Depot profiles provide details of stockrooms within the company which are allowed to have sales orders raised on them. There is a Maintenance and an Enquiry function available, allowing you to set up, maintain and enquire upon the stockroom profiles of those stockrooms assigned to Drinks Sales Order Processing as depot.

The most important items of information are as follows:

Allocation Priority

The default priority for orders to be despatched from the stockroom.

Allocation Time Fence

The allocation time fence is a period of time in days. If the delivery due date is less than the current date plus the time fence, allocation will be attempted.

Prices and Discounts

In order to get the full benefit from Drinks Sales Order Processing, pricing and discounting should be performed by the module. This reduces errors, and hence credit notes and customer irritation. The system provides for pricing to be performed at both order entry, using customer and item criteria, or at despatch. Alternatively, prices and discounts may be set manually. Many price and discount lists can be set up. This may be necessary for a number of reasons, for example, different market sectors, customers or multiple currencies. Discounting can be based upon quantity or value and may be given in terms of percentage or value. A discount may apply to an item, a range of items or the whole order. Customers may be entitled to special discounts depending on their method of payment and the time it takes them to pay. However, certain considerations must be examined before setting up the price list:-

- Who, within your organisation, will be allowed to maintain lists? This authority is specified on the price/discount list profile which must be set up for each list.

- How many lists do you require? Will you wish to set up lists which are unique to individual customers, or for use on special orders?
- Within your discount lists, will you be able to specify discounts for groups of items, or are they to be specified for individual items? Will you use whole order discounts?

Effectivity dates can be used to control the module of new prices and discounts.

Price Lists

A price list can be used throughout the company or for an individual customer or for a customer group.

The item or item group entries within a price list have an effectivity start date so that price changes may be entered onto the system in advance of their introduction.

Global increases by percentage can be applied to an individual price list. A new list may be created by copying an existing list.

Discount Lists

A discount list can be applied throughout a company, or to an individual customer, or to a customer group, in a similar manner to price lists.

Discounts can be based on quantity or value breaks, either in the form of a percentage or an amount.

A discount can be allocated to an individual item, or alternatively the same discount can be given to all items in a discount group.

A discount group is an attribute of an item and is set up in Item Maintenance to group related items for discounting purposes.

Delivery Note Messages

There is a maintenance option allowing special messages to be set up for printing exclusively on delivery notes. These messages can relate to specific customer attributes - for example:-

- Region.
- Territory.
- Depot.
- Division.

Trailer Details

This option allows the set-up and maintenance of Trailers - detailing numbers, owning centres and service details - which can be referenced in Order Entry/Amendment, Tagged Goods Returns and Uplift Processing.

In conjunction with Drinks Distributed Requirements Planning (DRP), information regarding the last two locations (and associated dates) of any trailer can be enquired upon, enabling you to know when a trailer's service is due, and where that trailer is located (at which internal depot).

If Drinks DRP is not attached, the trailer number can be used at Confirm Assembly time to note which trailer orders/loads were used. The number

entered during Confirmation of Assembly prints on the Delivery Note for your information.

Credit Controllers

This maintenance option allows users to be authorised as Credit Controllers for Suspended Order Release.



New controllers can added by typing the User ID and name in the input fields at the bottom of the screen and pressing **Enter**.

State & City Profiles

The State & City Profiles are used throughout the Sales Details of Drinks Sales Order Processing to provide restrictions in the following areas:

- Buying Lists.
- Taxation State.
- City Code.
- Tax Group.

Order Processing Cycle

Drinks Sales Order Processing has six main procedures:

- Enter order details.
- Stock allocation.
- Pricing, discounting and credit checking.
- Pick items from stock and despatch.
- Confirm Delivery. (This is detailed in the Picking & Despatches Section).
- Raise invoice.

Each one of these procedures has a number of tasks each with a large number of options.

Enter Order Details

The Drinks System provides two major types of order entry - Telesales or Sales Order Entry. During Sales Order Entry there is the ability for rapid data entry from an order pad, for example, and there is the ability to be more selective at order entry (e.g. examining stock availability).

There are three phases:

- Order header.
- Order lines.
- Extra charges.

There are also two alternative types of order:

- Tagged Goods.
- Uplift.

Order Header

The customer is identified and the standard defaults such as pricing, allocation rules, currency, supplying depot and trading terms are retrieved. The currency of an order may be changed to any currency specified in the General Ledger if the customer is able to place multi-currency orders.

Order Lines

Sales Orders are entered one item at a time with opportunity to discuss availability and offer alternatives. In this instance, stock allocation is normally interactive, taking into account the required due date for the order line. Drinks has function whereby stockrooms can be linked together providing multiple stockroom allocation if required.

Extra Charges

Standard extra charges may be held on the descriptions file. These may be viewed and added to an order during the closing procedure. The actual charge may be retrieved from the file or entered specifically for the order.

Order Acknowledgement & Proforma Invoice

As a way to inform customers that their orders are being processed you have the option to print out acknowledgements.

Customers may also be defined as Cash with Order, with the ability to create a Proforma Invoice so as to obtain payment prior to allocation / picking / despatch.

Stock Allocation

When an order line is considered for allocation, whether interactively or in batch, the due date is compared with the time fence for the depot (this time fence is the number of days required to prepare and deliver orders to the customer). Thus stock is allocated as late as practical and maximum flexibility is retained. During batch allocation it is necessary to sequence order lines for allocation to enable high priority orders to be met. The priority of an order can be taken from the customer or entered at order time. If low priority orders are not satisfied their priority can be increased automatically. This means that at some time their priority becomes the highest and they take precedence.

During stock allocation you may find stock shortages, so it is possible to identify alternatives. There is also a feature whereby allocation can take place even though there is a shortage up to a certain level. (This is called negativity).

Alternative items and kit lists are used within Drinks Sales Order Processing, but are set up and maintained in Drinks Inventory Management. If you do set up alternatives, it is important to decide whether a relationship is reversible. Where kits are used, the issues relating to the update of Drinks Sales Analysis need to be addressed - should details of the whole kit, parent only or components only be passed? The indicator governing this update is maintained on the item definition in Drinks Inventory Management.

Pricing, Discounting and Credit Checking

In order to get the full benefit from computerised Sales Order Processing, pricing and discounting should be performed by the system. This means that it must have a fundamentally flexible approach to pricing and discounting. The actual price and discounts charged are a function of the trading relationship with the customer, therefore, the trading currency is assumed to be the prime currency of the customer's account. This information is part of the additional data held for customers.

It is possible to set up Price / Discount lists based on various combinations of: Item, Item Group, Customer, or Customer Group.

The various price and discount lists are searched in priority sequence to determine the actual price and discounts which will apply to a particular order line.

In some cases the prices charged on the invoice are dependent upon the date the order is received. In other instances the price and discount is determined at the time of despatch. The Drinks Sales Order Processing system provides for these decisions to be made for the company in general, for the customer or specifically for the order.

Prices and discounts are defined as follows:

Price

In the prime currency of the customer account.

Taken from a price list at order entry or despatch.

Expressed in the selling units of the order (multiplied by a conversion factor on the price list if required).

Discount 1

A percentage or value.

A discount for the item / item group as given on the discount list.

A variable discount depending upon the value or quantity volume of the item sold.

Discount 2

A variable discount depending upon the value of the whole order.

Credit Checking

Credit checking does not prevent the entry of an order into the module. However, orders that fail a credit check are suspended, i.e. are ignored by stock allocation, and have to be released.

Credit checking is performed when:

- The order is entered, in which case the outstanding debt is compared with the credit limit and the credit stop flag is checked.

- Allocation takes place, when the outstanding debt and the current outstanding allocations are both considered.

A customer may be within a hierarchy.

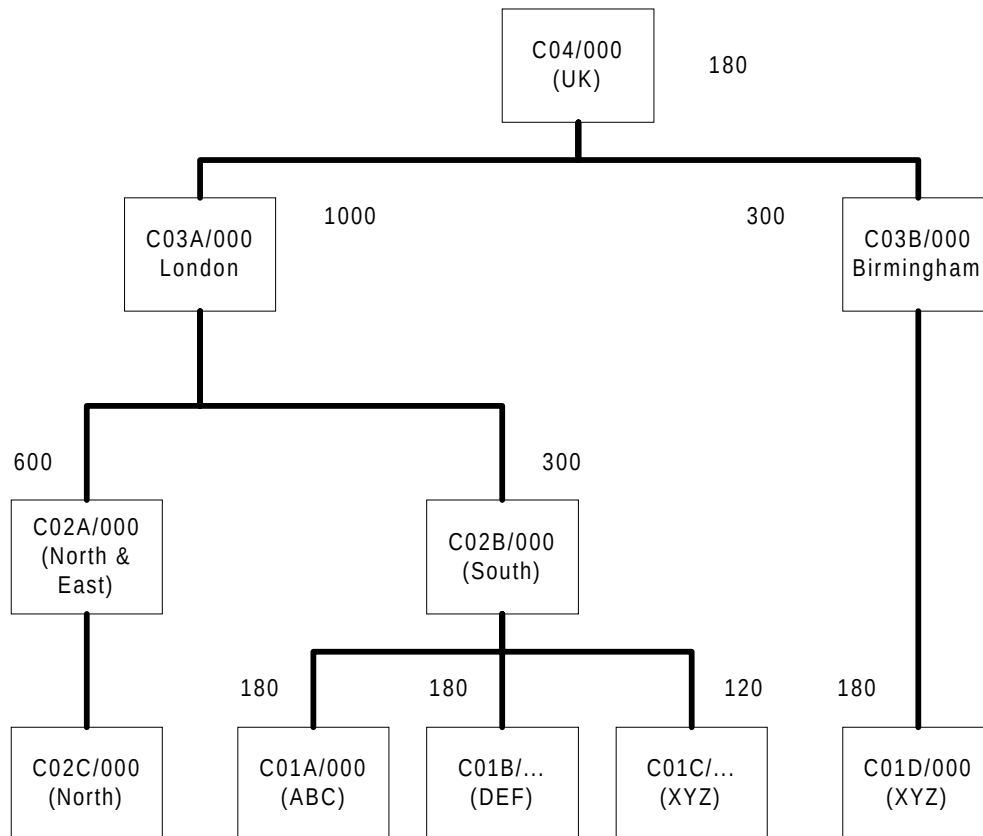
The module provides for the storage of two credit limits - commercial and insured. The commercial value is used for credit checking purposes.

Orders for customers who have exceeded their credit limit are suspended with the code 'CL', and for customers who have been placed on credit stop with the code 'CS.'

Hierarchy Credit Checking

The credit check and account summary balance update functions within Drinks Sales Order Processing, take account of any payment hierarchies in which the customer is defined.

Consider the following hierarchical relationship:



*Note: Credit Limits are shown in **bold** typeface.*

When the credit checking process takes place, it is performed at each level. (Refer to the diagram whilst following the example.)

Examples:

Example 1:

- ABC place an order for £180:
 - C01A/, C02B/, C03A/ and C04/ credit limits are checked.

- If credit check passes, stock allocation takes place and available credit is reduced by the order value.
- ABC place another order for £50:
 - First order not yet cleared, therefore available credit is currently at £0.00.
 - CO1A/ fails credit check. The order is suspended and reason code 'HL' is assigned to it.
- DEF place an order for £180:
 - CO1B/ credit limit is checked and passed.
 - When CO2B/ credit limit is checked the order is suspended, code 'HL'.
 - The reason for this is that the credit limit for CO2B/ has been reduced to £120 after ABC placed their order (account is still outstanding).

The credit checking process will also examine the status of the customer's account. The account may be flagged to indicate it is on hold for a number of reasons, e.g. too many outstanding debts, legal proceedings in progress. If this is the case higher up in the hierarchy, it will affect the customers that are defined in the lower levels.

Example 2:

- Account CO3A/ is stopped and ABC place an order for £50:
 - CO1A/ and CO2B/ accounts pass the credit checking process.
 - The order is still suspended as the higher account CO3A/ is on hold. This will be indicated by the suspension code 'HS'.

Or

- Account CO4/ is being taken to court and ABC place an order for £50:
 - Account CO1A/ CO2B/ and CO3A/ all pass the credit checks.
 - The order is again suspended as the higher account CO4/ has been flagged as status 'L'.
 - At order entry the suspension code 'HT' will be assigned to the order.



Note: The suspension codes can be viewed by the Description Enquiry in the Sales Order Maintenance menu. They are held in the Description file, major type 'SUSP'.

Hierarchy Customer Account Structure

The hierarchical account structure is a new feature incorporated within Drinks Sales Order Processing. It is an expansion of the two level structure, whereby, you can have a parent account with a lower level of ordering customers. For example, Giles' HQ is the parent customer and the Giles' retail shops are the second level of customers.

The system allows you to have up to 4 different levels of customers:

Level 4:

This is the highest level. It can be used to identify a parent establishment, which is likely to receive summaries of lower level activities, e.g. UK HQ. However, it is not a mandatory account and you are not permitted to assign any orders to it.



Note: You can have vertical and horizontal branches of level 4 attached to existing level 4 accounts.

Level 3:

Although no orders can be assigned to this account level, this is a mandatory account, e.g. London Office. It is used for financial account posting into the General Ledger, using the Accounts Receivable balance.



Note: You CANNOT have vertical branches of level 3. But you can have horizontal accounts of level 3 attached to a level 4 account.

Level 2:

This is an optional account, e.g. South London Office. No orders can be assigned to it. Its purpose is purely financial for cash allocation. Refer to the cash allocation section of Accounts Receivable for more information.



Note: You can have both vertical or horizontal branches of level 2 attached to level 2 or 3 accounts.

Level 1:

This is the lowest level of account possible. All orders are assigned to customers of this level, e.g. ABC. It is mandatory for Drinks Sales Order Processing. Accounts Receivable Ledger will be updated with postings from these accounts, through the invoicing jobs. Refer to the invoicing section for more details on invoicing.



Note: You CANNOT have vertical branches of level 1. But you can have horizontal accounts of level 1 attached to level 2 or 3 accounts.

To set up and maintain hierarchy accounts refer to the customer maintenance section of the Accounts Receivable Product Guide.

The main impact of hierarchy accounts for Drinks Sales Order Processing is credit checking. This takes place at order entry and allocation, and is affected by all the levels of accounts for that customer. This is discussed earlier in the Credit Checking section of this product information.

Picking and Despatching

Selection is provided to ensure that only the picking documents required are actually printed. The section can be for a single order or load or for a bulk pick list. This allows stock to be allocated to an order well in advance of despatch but the documents to be printed only when action is required. This is particularly useful in dealing with large export consignments. When a picking note is printed all allocations, irrespective of when they were made, are included.

This stops documents being produced unnecessarily. If the Drinks Warehousing module is installed, it must be used to despatch orders from warehouses in a similar manner. It is then possible to print consolidated picking lists sequenced by location.

When the order has been physically despatched the module needs updating. A number of options and facilities are provided.

- The despatches are assembled i.e. taken from the stockroom where they have been picked to the stockroom from which they will be delivered. This enables items from different stockrooms to be gathered for a single load.
- Delivery notes are printed.
- The assembled despatches are delivered and the delivery is confirmed. It may be that some organisations will carry out this process on return of the delivery advice note from the customer - i.e. on Proof of Delivery.
- Despatch alterations may take place either during confirmation of assembly or during confirmation of delivery. This enables, for example, the amendment of quantities because of shortages during picking, or breakage during delivery.

For lot / batch / serial controlled items details of lots / batches must be specified to the despatch lines. This provides the system with information for stock management and item traceability. These features are useful to locate the source of an item sent out to customers. For example, if a damaged case of whiskey has been delivered to a customer, instead of freezing all stocked whiskey, it would be more effective to identify the whiskey batch/lot source and freeze only those from that particular batch/lot. Orders can be altered so that another stockroom / depot can be used for despatch items.

Invoicing

There are a number of ways to request an invoice. These are:

- Confirm the assembly or delivery of an order.
- Request a sundry invoice - with stock update.
- Request a sundry invoice - without stock update.

There are also requests for credit notes that operate in an identical fashion to the requests for sundry invoices, and can be generated for Uplift orders and Tagged Goods returns.

When an invoice or credit note is generated in the system, prices and discounts are either taken from the order, as in Confirm Assembly, or created during entry using standard rules. There is a special facility to produce a credit note that is based on an invoice. This can be used to reverse a previous posting that was perhaps raised in error.

Having generated the invoice or credit note a procedure is run to post the transactions to Accounts Receivable and the General Ledger, and to print documents. Invoices and credit notes are printed as two separate documents.

An invoice will be raised and printed in the prime currency of the customer's account. Postings will be in both prime currency and the base currency of Accounts Receivable. The data that is passed to Drinks Sales Analysis will be in the base currency of the company.

Invoices can be presented to customers as:

- One invoice per despatch.
- One Invoice per order.
- One invoice per day.
- One invoice per week.
- One invoice per period.

The level of consolidation is defined for each customer invoice account.

This means numerous despatches to many delivery addresses can be consolidated on a single invoice. Each despatch is detailed on the invoice at line level with charges as applied.

Orders raised with an invoice address override are not consolidated and will produce an invoice for each despatch.

Credits and sundry invoices are not consolidated and a separate document is produced for each one raised.

The system determines when an open invoice is to be closed, posted to Accounts Receivable and printed during the invoice print procedure. This is based on:

One Invoice Per Despatch (And Sundry Invoices And Credits)

Processed during the invoice print following creation.

One Invoice Per Order

Processed during the next invoice print run.

One Invoice Per Day

Processed during the first invoice print after the date of consolidation.

One Invoice Per Week

Processed during the first invoice print after the Inventory week-end date for the week of consolidation.

One Invoice Per Period

Processed during the first invoice print after the Inventory period-end date for the period of consolidation.

Bills Of Exchange

Bills of Exchange may be created by Drinks Sales Order Processing as part of the invoice run, one proposed Bill of Exchange being sent to the customer for each invoice. This Bill of Exchange may be signed by the customer and returned, or they may issue their own Bill of Exchange, possibly to cover several invoices. This is then registered on the Accounts Payable module and may be allocated against invoices in the normal way. The exposure is monitored until the Bill of Exchange is cleared.



Note: Bills of exchange will only be printed if the Payment Method on the Bank Detail screen (Accounts Receivable Customer Maintenance) is set to 'E'.

Enquiries

The Enquiries in Drinks Sales Order Processing are designed to provide rapid and complete access to the data contained within the system and to display it in an efficient and ergonomic manner.

A significant part of the work done in a busy sales office is answering queries.

These are typically regarding:

- The status of an order.
- The prices being charged and discounts given.
- The date on which a delivery can be expected.
- Invoice or credit note queries.

The system provides a comprehensive range of enquiries to view:

Orders By:

- Order.
- Customer.
- Item.
- Cross Reference (customer reference).
- Despatch notes.

Invoices By:

- Invoice.
- Order.
- Customer.
- Item.

Stock Availability

Time-phased expected stock position.

Stock Position

Stock holding at each depot.

As well as these day-to-day enquires, the following module reference data can be displayed:

- Customers.
- Items.
- Price & Discount Lists.

Reports

Reports can be grouped into status, exception and planning reports, as follows:

Status:

- Customers.
- Items.
- Product Summary.
- List of Orders.
- Freeloaders' Sales.

Exception

- Unconfirmed Picking Notes.
- Unconfirmed Documents.
- Non-Returned Tagged Goods.
- Suspended Orders.
- Suspended Order History.
- Orders With Zero Price.
- Gross Margin Exceptions.
- Selling Price Overrides.
- Zero Value Invoice Lines.
- Confirm Delivery Amendments.
- Credits by Delivery Date.

Planning

- Pick Lists.
- Outstanding Orders.
- Back Orders.
- Stock Versus Outstanding Orders.
- Wanted Trailers.
- Trailer Location.
- Customer Container Tracking.
- Depot Container Movements.

Initial Data Take-on

Once all the basic data has been set up, you are ready to use the module to process sales orders. You may wish to convert outstanding sales orders from another module - this may be done by specially-written programs. Alternatively, you may decide to continue to process existing orders on your old module, and enter new orders, from a given date, into the new module. By this method you may gradually run down orders on the old module and build the order bank on the new, but great care must be exercised over the updating of the inventory figures.

Preparation

Preparing to use Drinks Sales Order Processing requires careful planning and preparation. Your existing system procedures and data need to be transferred to the module.

Entering Basic Data

You must initialise your module by entering the following basic data:

Company Profile

This is a record which contains control and parameter information for the operation of your company within the module.

Statement Account

A customer must be set up within Accounts Receivable before any sales orders can be posted to it. When the basic data has been created you are in a position to enter transactions.

Invoice Account

If the customer's address, defined in Accounts Receivable is not to be used for the invoices, a separate invoice account needs to be set up. This is created using Drinks Sales Order Processing, and is discussed later in the customer maintenance section.

Currency Exchange Rates

If you have multi-currency customers you must set up the valid currency exchange rates. These are set up in the General Ledger.

When you have set up the basic data and the Drinks Inventory Management module is in play, you can start using Drinks Sales Order Processing.

Installing Application Manager PTF's

Application Manager PTF's must be restored and installed as QSECOFR.



Note: To install the Application Manager PTF's the system must be in a minimum state (that is with no users or subsystems / jobs running - this is important)

Use a normal User ID to create the state then sign off and sign on as QSECOFR.

At the first screen, add in library OSLPTP1 (ADDLIB OSLPTP1 *FIRST)

Type in MNGPTF and install the PTF as normal.

Once installed, the library and PTF object can only be removed by QSECOFR. Install this PTF then sign off and sign back in as PTFOwner for subsequent PTF's.

If the above is NOT done, PTFOwner, being inside Application manager, will say the AM PTF is installed when it has not, as PTFOwner is using one of the objects the PTF requires, and the system will work - but will NOT have been updated.